

CYNTIA KIFEH

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cloud Infrastructure Engineer with 8+ years of U.S.-based experience designing, building, and securing cloud platforms across Azure and AWS environments. Skilled in cloud architecture, Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, ARM, CloudFormation, Bicep), and automation scripting with PowerShell, Python, and Bash. Proven ability to deploy resilient Kubernetes (AKS/EKS) solutions, lead containerization efforts, and drive automation initiatives at scale. Strong background in systems engineering and cloud platform administration, with a passion for building scalable, secure environments that enable rapid innovation. Known for hands-on execution, proactive problem-solving, and a focus on delivering practical, sustainable solutions.

CORE SKILLS & TOOLS

- **Cloud Platforms:** AWS, GCP, Azure
- **Security Tools:** AWS IAM, KMS, GuardDuty, Security Hub, Config, CloudTrail, GCP Security Command Center, Azure Defender
- **IAM & Access Control:** Role-based Access, OPA, SAML, OAuth 2.0, Workload Identity Federation
- **Encryption:** TLS, SSL, KMS, customer-managed keys, HashiCorp Vault
- **DevSecOps:** CI/CD security (GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Cloud Build), image scanning (Trivy, Clair), SAST/DAST
- **Automation & Configuration Management:** Terraform, Ansible, CloudFormation, GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps
- **Vulnerability Management:** SAST (SonarQube), DAST (OWASP ZAP, Burp Suite), Prisma Cloud, CrowdStrike Falcon
- **Monitoring and Incident Response:** Splunk, ELK Stack, AWS CloudWatch, Azure Monitor
- **Programming:** Python, Bash, PowerShell
- **Cloud Security Architecture** (AWS, Azure, GCP)
- **Zero Trust Network Architecture**
- **Infrastructure as Code (IaC):** Terraform, CloudFormation, Pulumi
- **Container Security:** Kubernetes RBAC, PodSecurityPolicies, Network Policies, Docker best practices
- **Logging & Monitoring:** CloudWatch, Cloud Logging, Splunk, Datadog, SIEM Integration
- **Compliance & Governance:** GDPR, HIPAA, SOC 2, ISO 27001, NIST 800-53, CIS Benchmarks
- **Cloud-Native Application Security**
- **Compliance Automation & Monitoring**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES

CLOUD ENGINEER | TekGlobal Inc

AUG 2022 – PRESENT

- Designed and deployed Azure and AWS cloud architectures, implementing secure, scalable infrastructure using ARM templates, Bicep, and Terraform.
- Led automation initiatives by scripting custom PowerShell and Python solutions for cloud resource management, saving hundreds of manual hours annually.
- Built and maintained a multi-region Kubernetes architecture (AKS and EKS), ensuring high availability, disaster recovery, and auto-scaling for critical workloads.
- Spearheaded Infrastructure as Code adoption across teams, introducing GitOps practices to streamline deployments and enhance compliance tracking.
- Architected automated CI/CD pipelines with GitLab CI and Azure DevOps, integrating security checks and policy enforcement early in the build cycle.
- Implemented centralized monitoring and alerting systems using Azure Monitor, CloudWatch, and custom Grafana dashboards for real-time system health visibility.
- Automated the remediation of security vulnerabilities using AWS Lambda and Azure Functions, dramatically reducing incident response times.
- Orchestrated container migration projects, containerizing legacy applications for deployment on AKS and EKS, cutting deployment time by 70%.
- Deployed Azure Landing Zones using accelerators, enabling rapid, compliant cloud environment build-outs for new business units.
- Developed Infrastructure Drift Detection systems to automatically detect and correct deviations from Terraform-managed states.
- Integrated AWS Config and Azure Policy across accounts, automating compliance reporting and enforcement of security baselines.
- Established a serverless architecture for several internal services, leveraging AWS Lambda and Azure Functions to optimize scalability and cost.
- Led a cross-functional team to implement a comprehensive cloud cost management strategy, achieving a 30% monthly cost reduction.
- Designed multi-account AWS Organizations structures with Control Tower to improve governance and security segmentation.
- Provided architecture reviews and guidance for new projects, ensuring alignment with cloud best practices and security standards.

Cloud Security Engineer | Cisco Systems

MAR 2020 – AUG 2022

- Designed and implemented secure, resilient cloud infrastructures across AWS, Azure, and GCP platforms, applying CIS benchmarks and cloud-native security tools.

- Integrated Terraform and CloudFormation templates into the secure CI/CD pipelines, improving automation, speed, and compliance of cloud deployments.
- Automated IaC security scanning using SAST tools within GitHub Actions pipelines, ensuring vulnerabilities were caught and fixed early.
- Built Kubernetes security strategies (AKS/EKS), enforcing PodSecurityPolicies, RBAC, and runtime protection using native tools and OPA.
- Led the design and deployment of centralized SIEM integrations with cloud-native services to improve threat visibility and response times.
- Developed PowerShell scripts and Ansible playbooks to automate the management of Azure and AWS resources, reducing deployment times.
- Deployed Zero Trust security models across multi-cloud environments, minimizing unauthorized access risks and securing identity management.
- Led vulnerability management initiatives using Prisma Cloud, SonarQube, and CrowdStrike Falcon to harden cloud-native applications.
- Implemented Azure Sentinel integrations for centralized security event correlation, improving incident response workflows.
- Built and maintained Platform as Code (PaC) modules using Terraform and Bicep templates to standardize deployments across environments.
- Conducted system hardening of EC2, AKS, and Azure VMs based on NIST 800-53 controls and CIS guidelines.
- Established continuous compliance monitoring pipelines, achieving real-time policy enforcement across multiple accounts.
- Supported hybrid cloud architecture deployments, integrating on-premises systems with AWS Direct Connect and Azure ExpressRoute.
- Led threat modeling exercises for new cloud-native applications, ensuring proactive security integration from design through deployment.
- Developed documentation and runbooks to streamline incident response, cloud governance, and operational excellence practices

CLOUD SECURITY ENGINEER | Avidity Tech

FEB 2017 – MAY 2020

- Implemented centralized governance and security monitoring across AWS and Azure Organizations using Security Hub, GuardDuty, and Azure Defender.
- Designed secure VPC and VNET architectures, using private subnets, NAT Gateways, and firewall solutions to minimize public exposure.
- Developed reusable Terraform modules and ARM templates to standardize secure cloud deployments across multiple teams.
- Automated continuous compliance assessments against CIS Benchmarks and NIST standards, reducing manual audit prep time by 50%.
- Implemented Kubernetes workload security best practices across AKS clusters, including network segmentation, RBAC, and secrets management.
- Wrote Python and PowerShell scripts to automate vulnerability remediation tasks, improving mean time to resolution by 60%.
- Led the deployment of container security tools like Prisma Cloud Compute to harden Kubernetes clusters and container registries.
- Automated patch management workflows for AWS EC2, Azure VMs, and Kubernetes nodes, ensuring security updates without service disruptions.
- Integrated threat intelligence feeds into SIEM platforms for proactive detection of emerging cloud threats.
- Delivered cloud security awareness sessions, improving secure coding and deployment practices among DevOps and engineering teams.
- Designed and implemented Azure Policy and AWS Config rules to enforce encryption, logging, and network security standards.
- Led incident response drills for cloud environments, simulating breach scenarios and validating IR readiness.
- Migrated legacy applications into containers and orchestrated deployments on AKS and EKS clusters, reducing infrastructure overhead.
- Conducted risk assessments for third-party SaaS integrations, ensuring compliance with GDPR and HIPAA requirements.
- Supported Azure Landing Zone development efforts, creating secure, scalable foundations for enterprise cloud adoption initiatives.

Bachelors in computer science | Presbyterian University of Cameroon

2022

Associates of Science | Prince George's Community College – Upper Marlboro, Maryland

2019

CERTIFICATIONS

- Salesforce Administrator
- CompTIA Security +
- ITIL Foundation Certification

PROJECTS

- Developed a comprehensive cloud security automation framework that reduced security incidents by 35% and vulnerability remediation time by 50%
- Designed a structured cloud-centric incident response playbook, integrated with SIEM tools and security orchestration, leading to a 25% reduction in mean time to resolve incidents
- Integrated SAST, DAST, and container security scanning into the CI/CD pipeline for cloud-native applications, reducing security-related production incidents by 55% and improving developer secure coding practices
- Conducted thorough cloud security assessments, hardened infrastructure to industry standards (CIS, NIST, SOC 2), and achieved a 40% reduction in attack surface across multi-cloud environments